The Night of the Big Storm

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: Review: animals, nature and ghosts
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 4–6 · read a story that uses the words of Units 4–6 and talk about storms and old stories



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

My grandfather lives in a **village** in the mountains, and every winter he tells the same story: the night of the big storm. When I was small, I **used to** ask for it again and again. Now I know it by heart, and I want to tell it to you.

It was a cold evening in January. My grandfather was walking home from the field with his old dog and a small lamb in his arms. The snow was falling slowly, and he was singing quietly. Everything was **calm**.

Suddenly the **weather** changed. The wind began to blow, and in a few minutes the snow was so thick that he could not see the path. He was not **aware** of the danger at first: it was a **normal** evening, and he was only thinking about dinner. But the dog was acting **badly**: it was running ahead, then coming back, and it **refused** to continue. “Be **patient**,” my grandfather told it. “We are almost there.”

After an hour he understood that they were lost. He did not shout and he did not run. He remembered what his grandfather used to say: stay calm, find a safe place and wait. He **followed** the dog to a big rock, and they sat down behind it.

While the storm was blowing, he heard a strange **voice** in the dark. It was thin and far away, like a **ghost**. For a moment he was afraid, but then he laughed: it was only the wind in the rocks. “A ghost on a night like this?” he said. “It has a bad **habit** of making a lot of noise.” The lamb was shaking, so he **rolled** his coat around it and held it close.

The Night of the Big Storm

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

Hours passed. He was **relaxing** a little and almost falling asleep when the dog began to bark. Far away he saw a small light. It was a neighbor with a lamp. The neighbor was walking through the snow, and he was calling: “Is anybody there?”

My grandfather could not **reach** the light alone, so he stood up and shouted with all his strength. The neighbor heard him, and they walked home together, with the **pet** dog in front and the lamb in my grandfather’s arms. It was a long **stroll** in the dark, but they were not afraid anymore. Nobody was **hurt**, and everybody was able to **escape** the storm.

When they arrived, my grandmother was waiting at the door. She was crying and laughing at the same time. “While you were walking in the snow,” she said, “I was making soup, and I was thinking only about you.” That night they ate together, and my grandfather said it was the best soup of his life.

My grandfather never forgot that night. He kept the neighbor’s lamp in a special place on the wall, and every winter he lit it again. It is not a very beautiful lamp, but for our family it is a small piece of history.

Stories like this are important in many mountain villages. They carry knowledge: how to read the sky, how to find shelter, how to call for help. Experts say that stories help people survive, because the mind remembers a story much better than a list of rules.

Every winter, when it snows, he tells us this story, and he always ends with the same sentence: “When you are lost, stay calm and wait for the light.” I think it is a good advice for any storm.

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: Review: animals, nature and ghosts

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 4–6, pages 27, 33 and 39. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
avoid v.	stay away from; not do	избегать	Avoid big dogs you don't know.
behave v.	act in a certain way	вести себя	The children behave well in class.
calm adj.	quiet, not nervous	спокойный	Stay calm and breathe slowly.
habit n.	something you do again and again	привычка	Brushing your teeth is a good habit.
patient adj.	able to wait without getting angry	терпеливый	Be patient: the bus is coming.
stroll v./n.	walk slowly for pleasure	прогуливаться; прогулка	We strolled in the park after dinner.
village n.	a very small town in the country	деревня, кишлак	My grandparents live in a village.
error n.	a mistake	ошибка	There is an error in your answer.
field n.	a large open area of land	поле	Cows were eating grass in the field.
hurt v.	cause pain	ранить, причинять боль; болеть	I hurt my knee yesterday.
rare adj.	not often seen; not common	редкий	White tigers are very rare.
relax v.	rest and feel calm	отдыхать, расслабляться	I relax in the evening.
wild adj.	living in nature, not with people	дикий	Wild animals live in forests.
escape v.	get away from a place or danger	убегать, сбегать	The bird escaped from its cage.
follow v.	go after someone or something	следовать, идти за	The ducklings follow their mother.
ghost n.	the spirit of a dead person	призрак	Do you believe in ghosts?
pet n.	an animal you keep at home	домашнее животное	My pet is a cat.
reach v.	get to a place; touch something far away	доставать; достигать	I can't reach the top shelf.
voice n.	the sound you make when you speak	голос	He has a beautiful voice.
weather n.	rain, sun, wind and temperature	погода	The weather was terrible yesterday.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: Review: animals, nature and ghosts · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

behave well / badly	вести себя хорошо / плохо
stay calm	сохранять спокойствие
break a bad habit	избавиться от вредной привычки
go for a stroll	пойти прогуляться
a rare animal	редкое животное
make an error	сделать ошибку
relax in nature	отдыхать на природе
bad weather	плохая погода
follow the path	идти по тропе
escape from danger	спастись от опасности
reach the top	добраться до вершины
a scary voice	страшный голос

Phrasal verbs

calm down	успокоиться	Calm down and think.
look after	присматривать	He looked after the lamb.
keep away from	держаться подальше	Keep away from the river.
carry on	продолжать	They carried on walking.
turn back	повернуть назад	The snow was deep, so we turned back.
get through	пережить	We got through the storm.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

storm	буря	**wind**	ветер
lamb	ягнёнок	**path**	тропа
lamp	лампа	**shiver**	дрожать
rock	скала	**shelter**	укрытие
snow	снег	**rescue**	спасать

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words

This week: revise **Book 1, Units 4–6**: the word pages 26–27, 32–33, 38–39 and the stories “The Dog’s Bell”, “The Jackal and the Sun Child” and “The Friendly Ghost”. Next: **Unit 7, “The Best Prince”**, pages 44–49.